

twitter.com/josefwho

Game Studies & Game Design 2

Josef Who?

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Overview/Schedule

Overview

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WS 2025/26

What?

Game Studies & Game Design

Josef Who?

Bewertung

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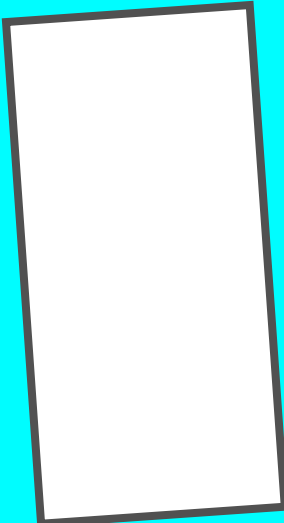
SS 2026

How?

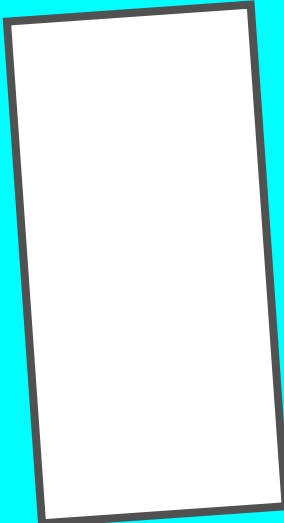
Game Studies & Game Design 2

Josef Who?

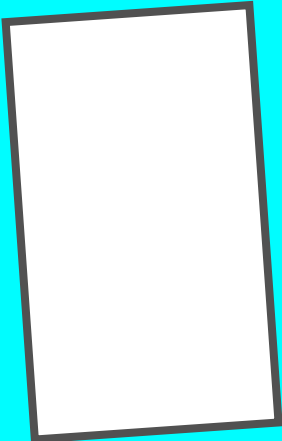
March



End of April

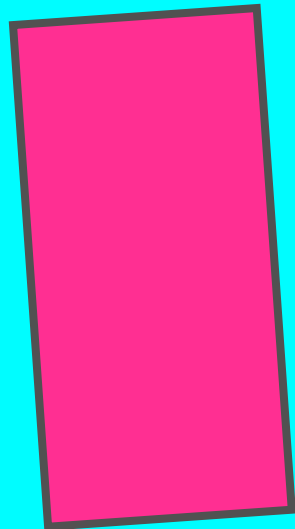


May 11

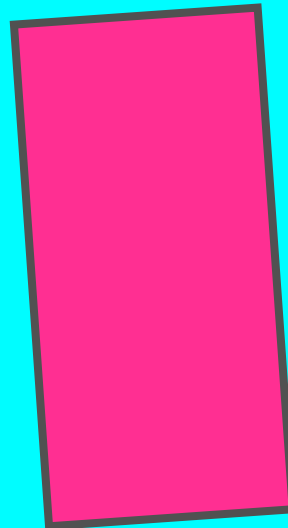


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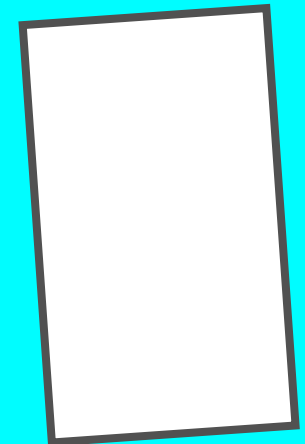
March



End of April



May 11

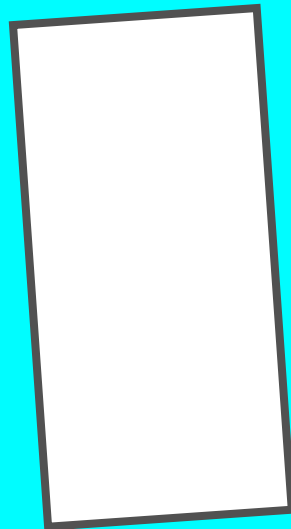


Theory and Hands-On Sessions

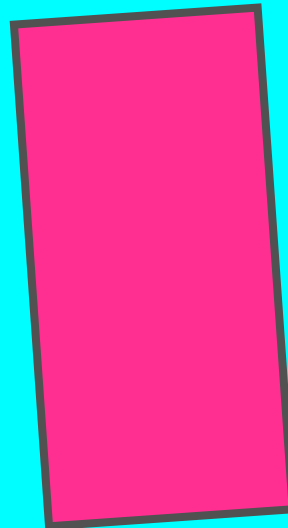
Josef Who?

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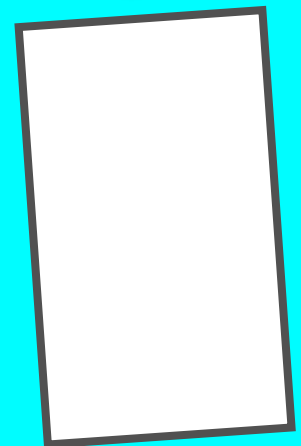
March



End of April



May 11

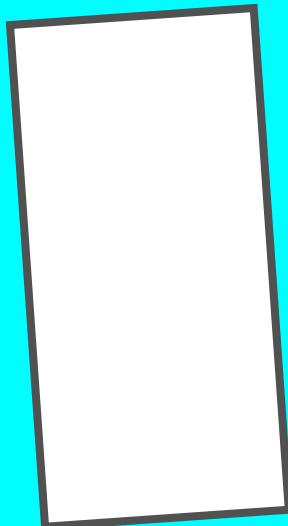


Submission: Analogue Game Treatment

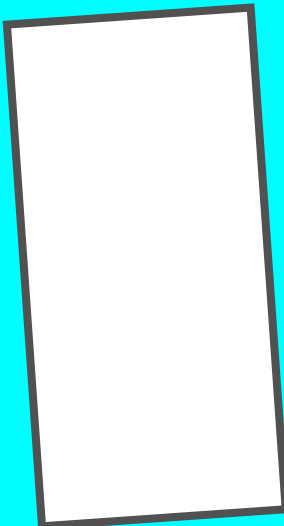
max 4 people per group

Josef Who?

March

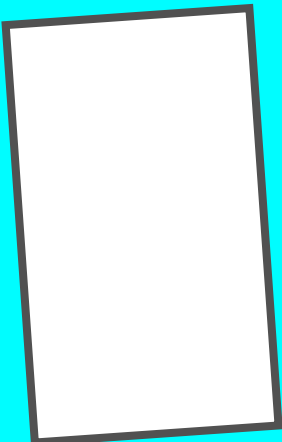


End of April



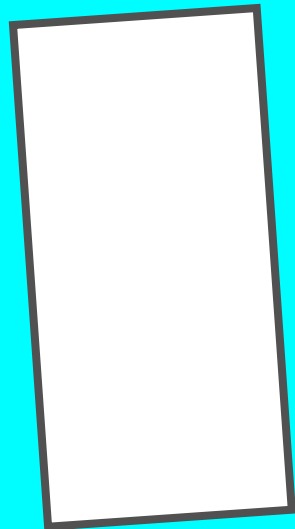
Feedback Josef

May 11

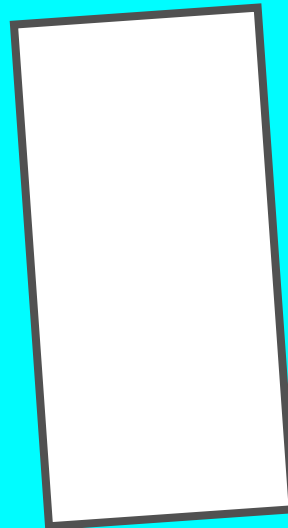


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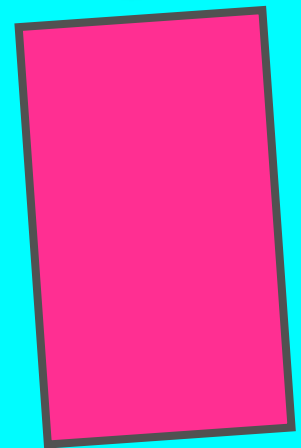
March



End of April



May 11



Presentations

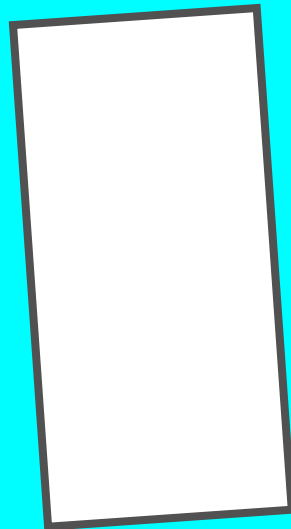
**10:00 - 13:15
for everyone!**

**Group A+B
together**

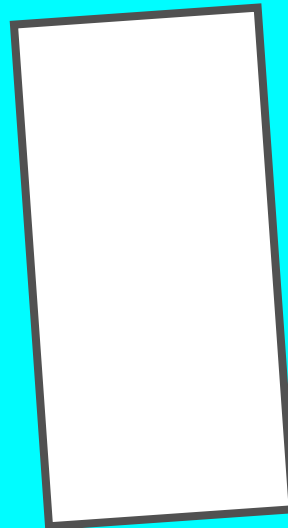
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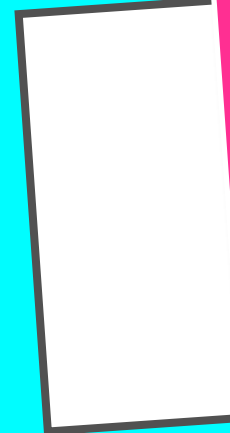
March



End of April



May 11



Abgabe
Add-On
Level
Design

Benotung
Josef
+Thomas

Josef Who?

Grading:

10% Attendance + 10% Participation

65% Submission Treatment

???

15% Submission Level Design

Benotungsschema:

100 - 92% Sehr Gut

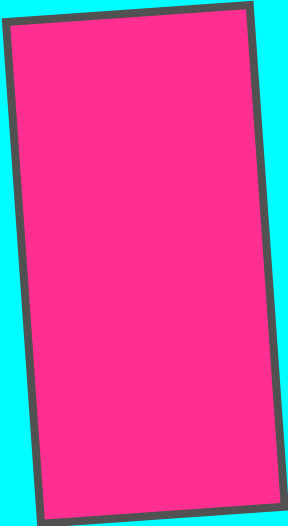
91 - 81% Gut

80- 67% Befriedigend

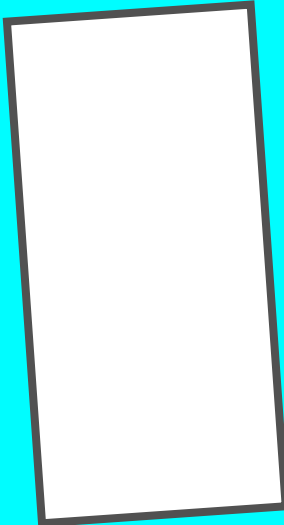
66- 50% Genügend

49- 0% Nicht Genügend

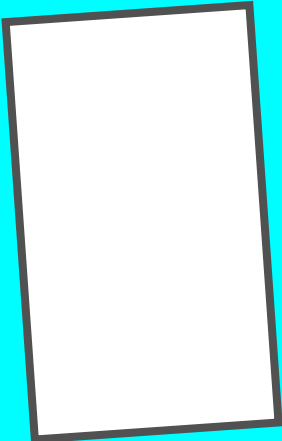
March



End of April



May 11



Day 1

Intro

Game Design Fingerübung
Game Treatment Submission
Quick introduction to MDA Framework
Play and adapt MDA Game

Overview

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FEEDBACK PLEASE!
ANY QUESTIONS SO FAR?

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Attendance

Josef Who?

Day 1

Fingerübung: Pattern for Pac-Man ghosts

Josef Who?

How does Pac-Man work?



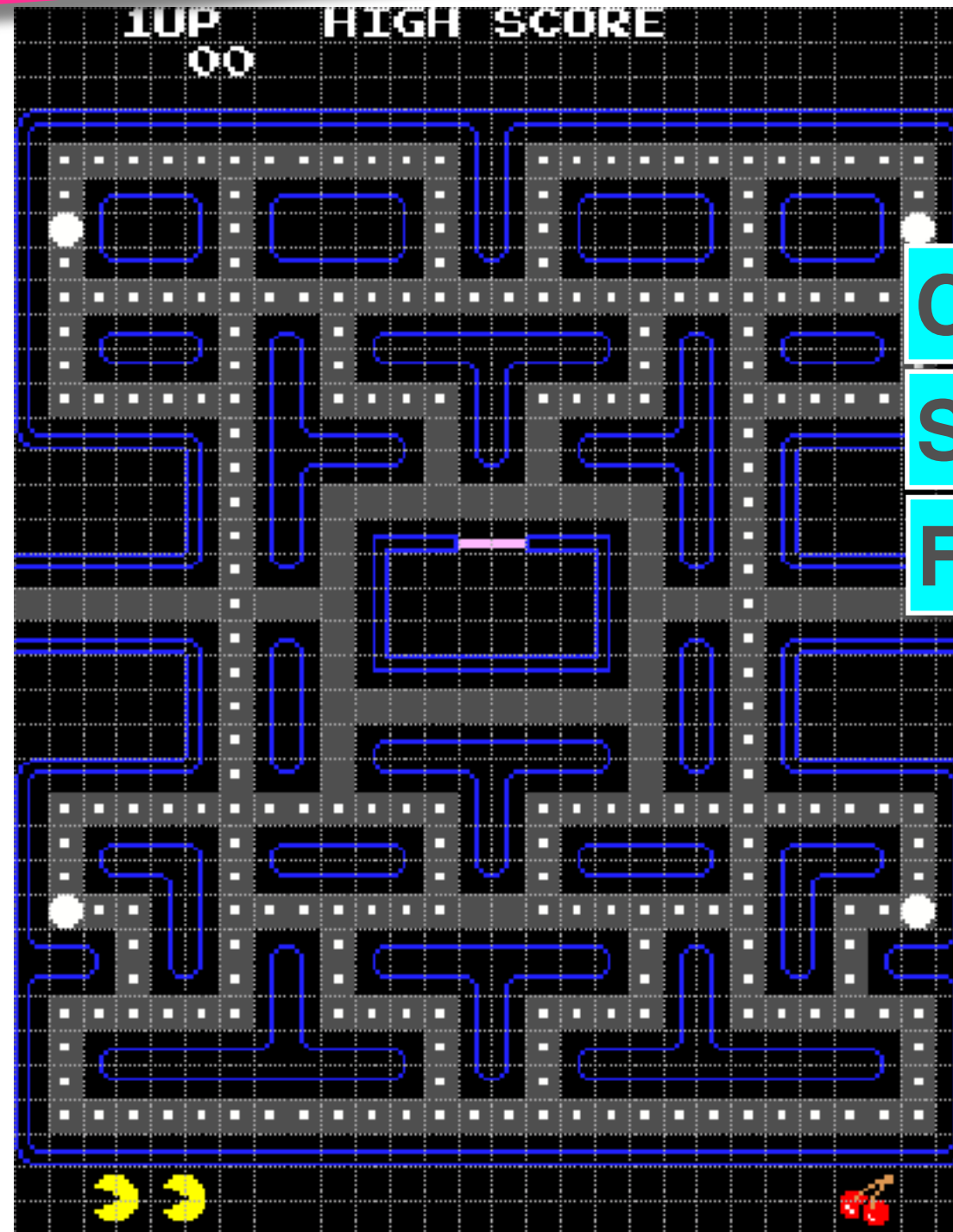
Frightened

Energizer

Pattern for Pac-Man ghosts

How does Pac-Man work?

Behaviours



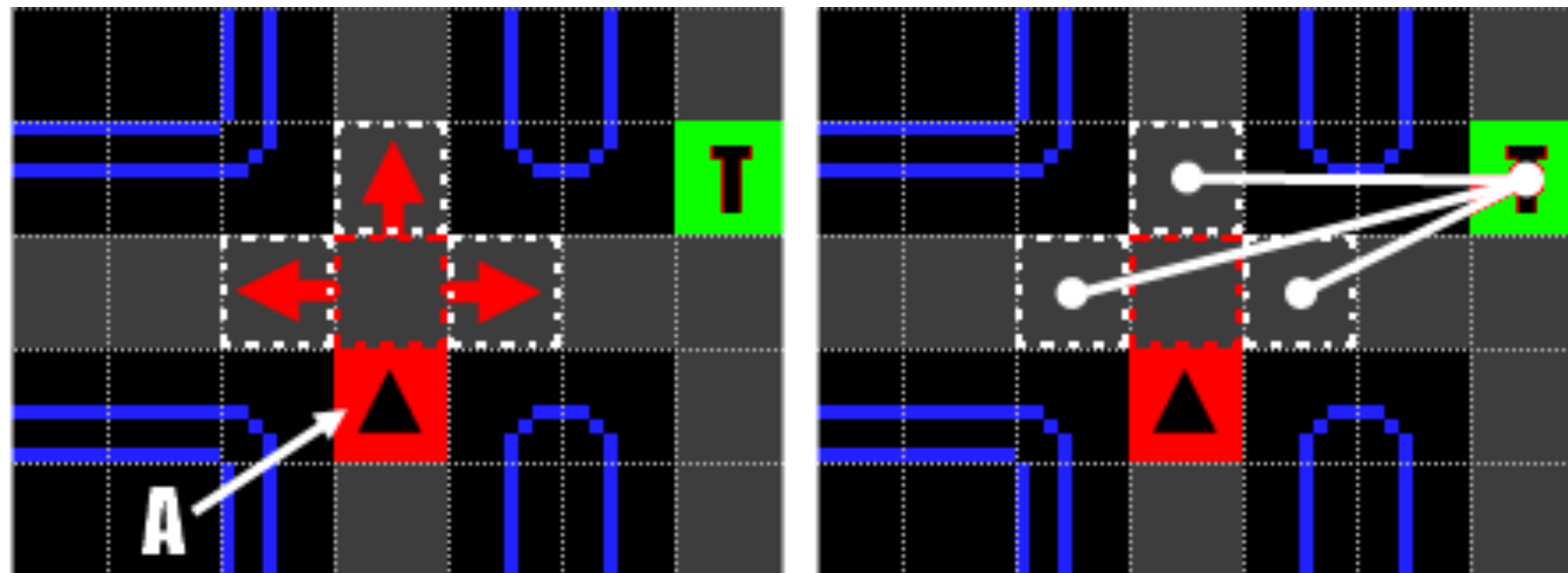
Chase

Scatter (4x)

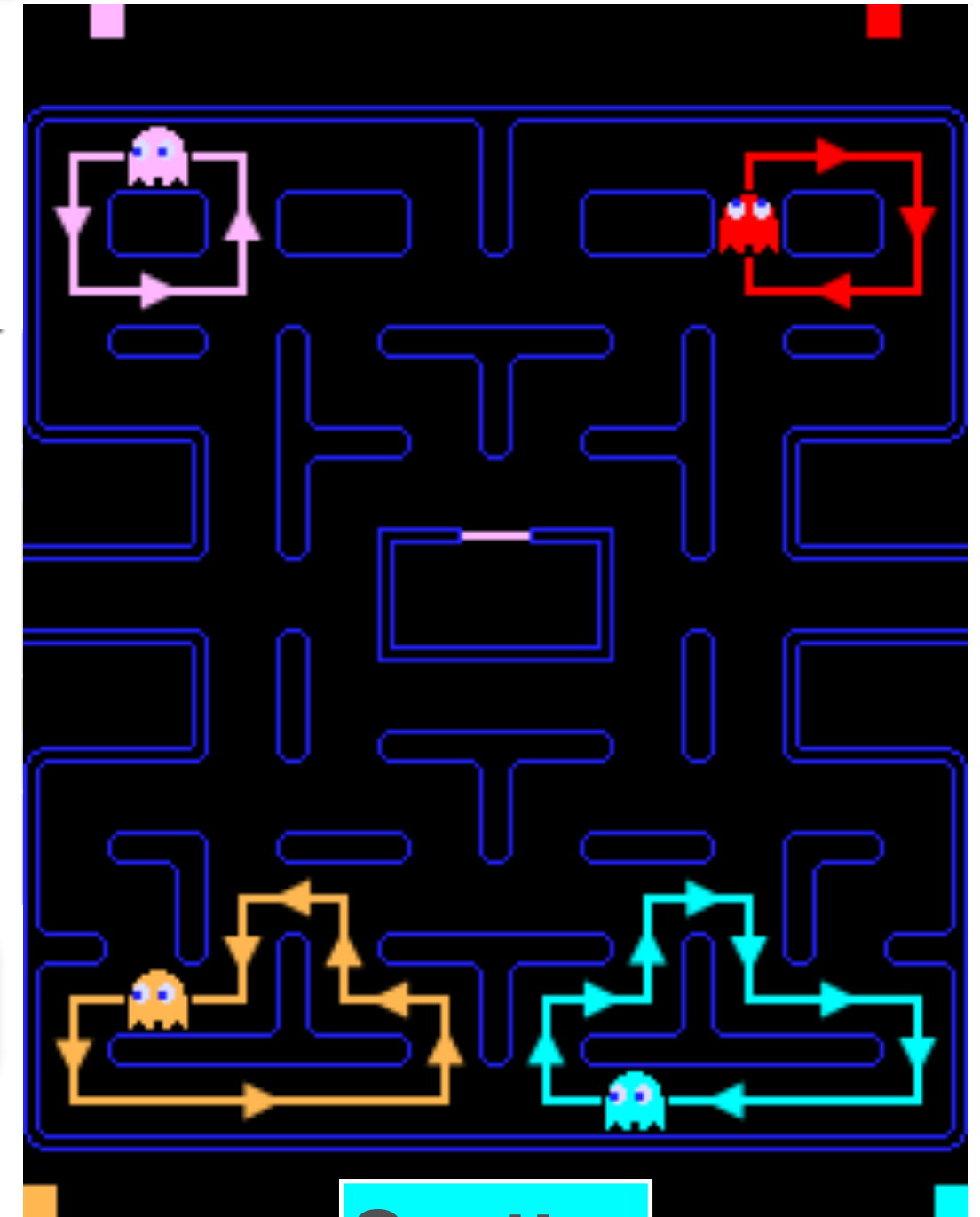
Frightened

Pattern for Pac-Man ghosts

How does Pac-Man work?



Pathfinding logic for all ghosts the same
but different target tiles



Scatter

Pattern for Pac-Man ghosts

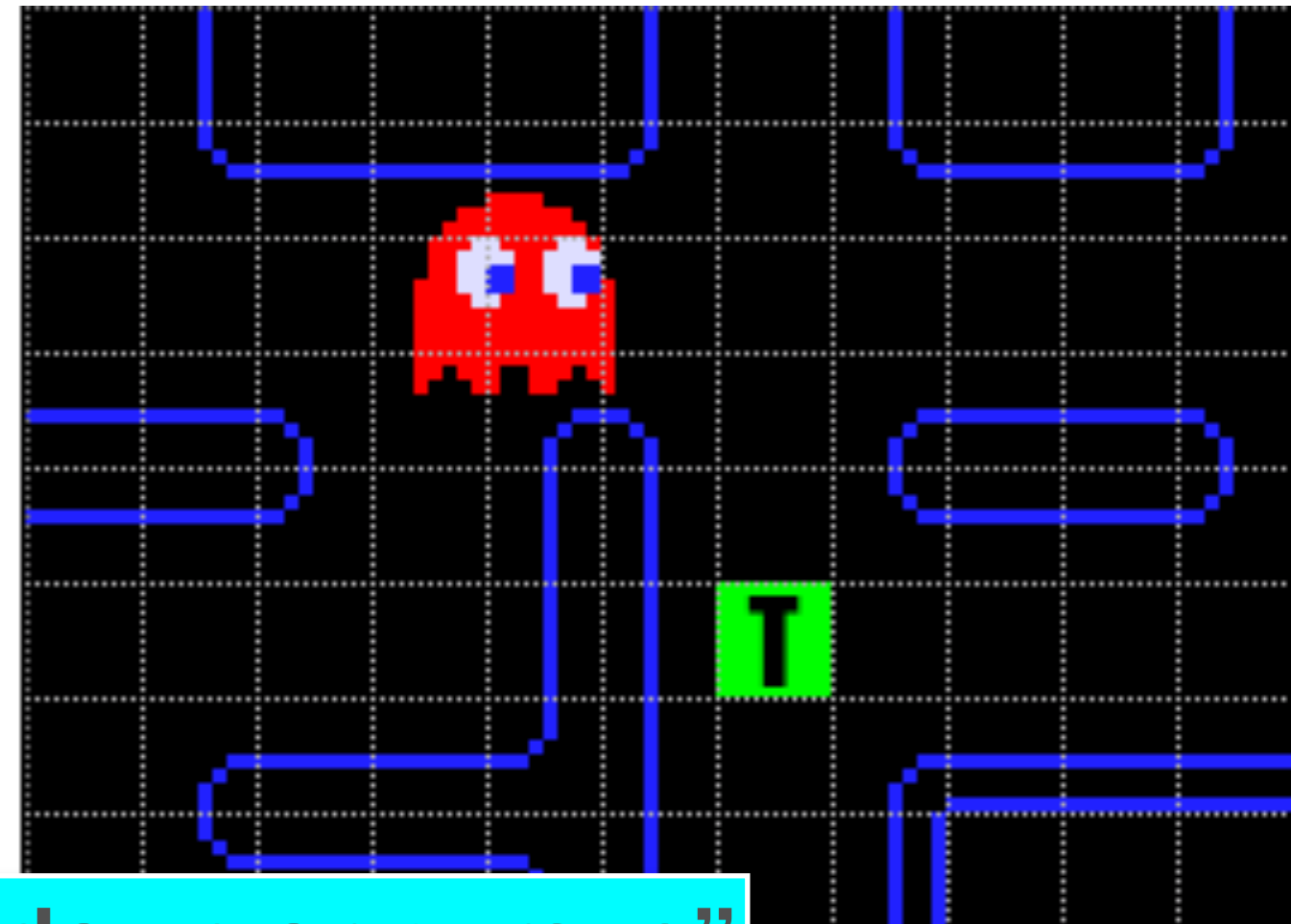
How does Pac-Man work?



**Oikake: “to run down or pursue”
Targets Pac-Man’s tile**

Pattern for Pac-Man ghosts

How does Pac-Man work?



Oikake: “to run down or pursue”
Targets Pac-Man’s tile

Pattern for Pac-Man ghosts

How does Pac-Man work?



Most aggressive
Speeds up when more dots are eaten

> Cruise Elroy

Pattern for Pac-Man ghosts

How does Pac-Man work?

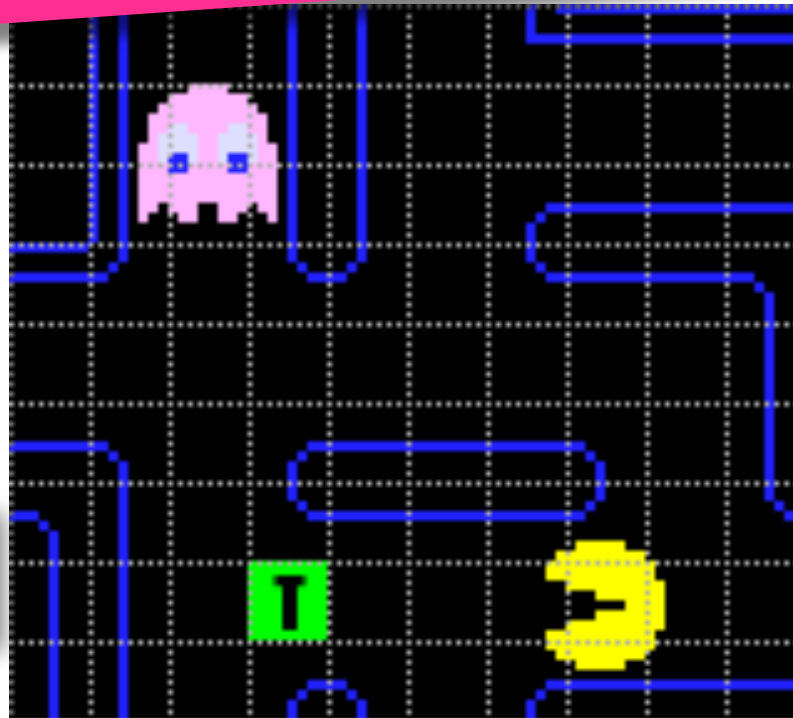


**Machibuse: “to perform an ambush”
Targets 4 tiles in front of Pac-Man**

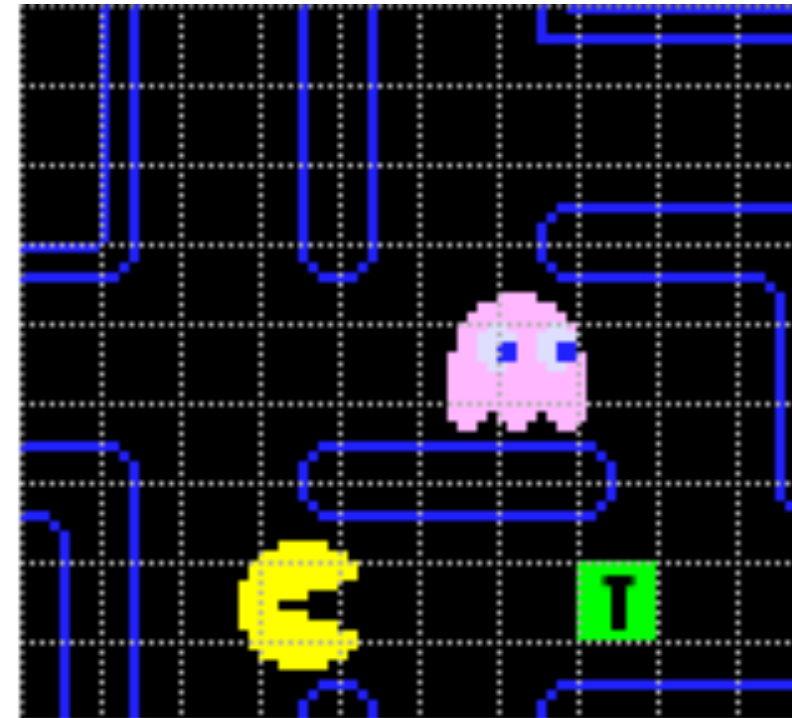
Pattern for Pac-Man ghosts

How does Pac-Man work?

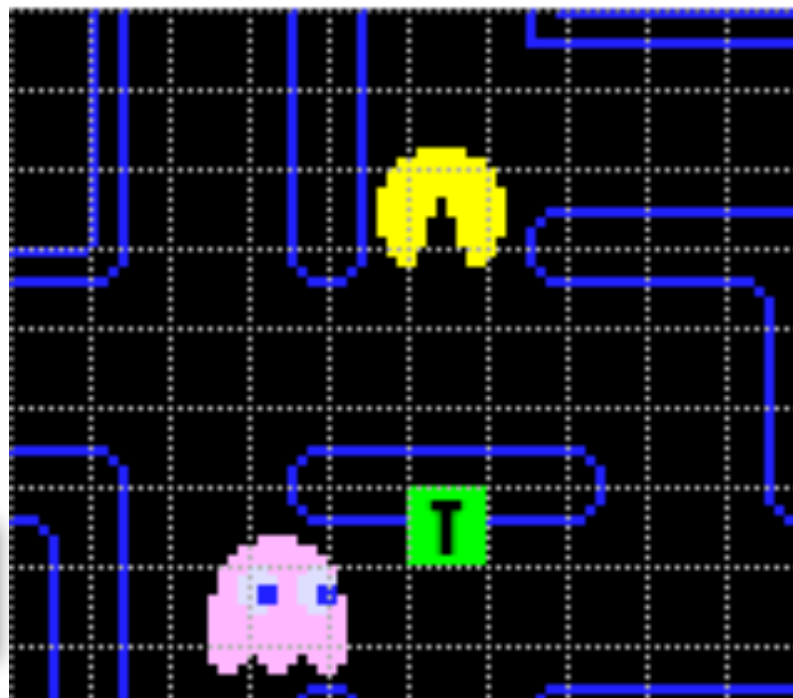
left



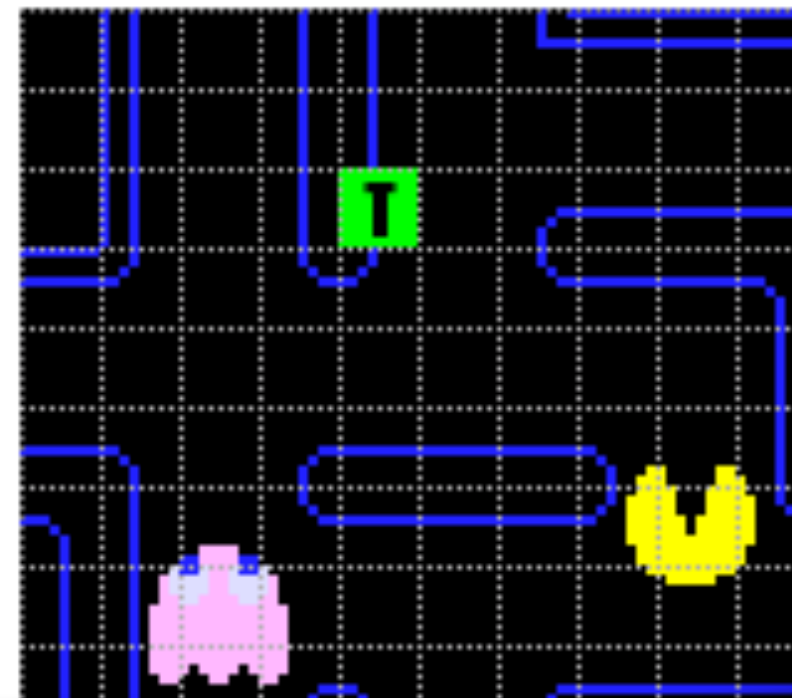
right



down



up



Machibuse: “to perform an ambush”
Targets 4 tiles in front of Pac-Man

small logic bug
Pattern for Pac-Man ghosts

How does Pac-Man work?

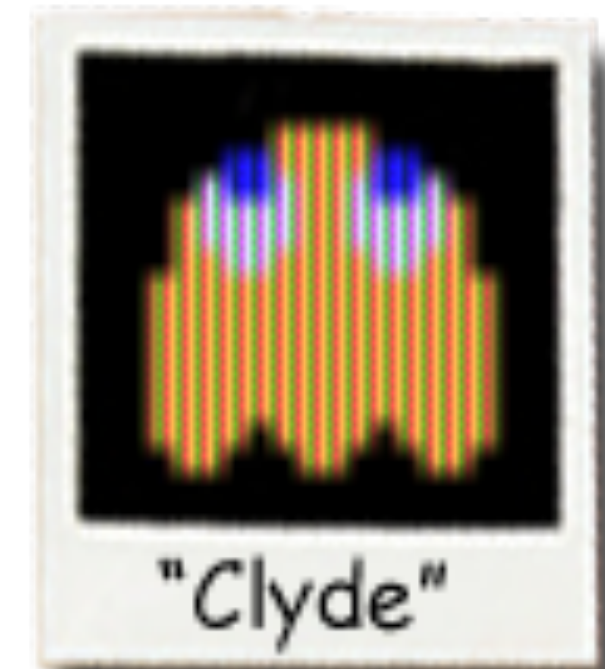


Cuts Pac-Man off
Often boxes Pac-Man in with Blinky
Bug in code when determining up target

Pattern for Pac-Man ghosts



Your turn!

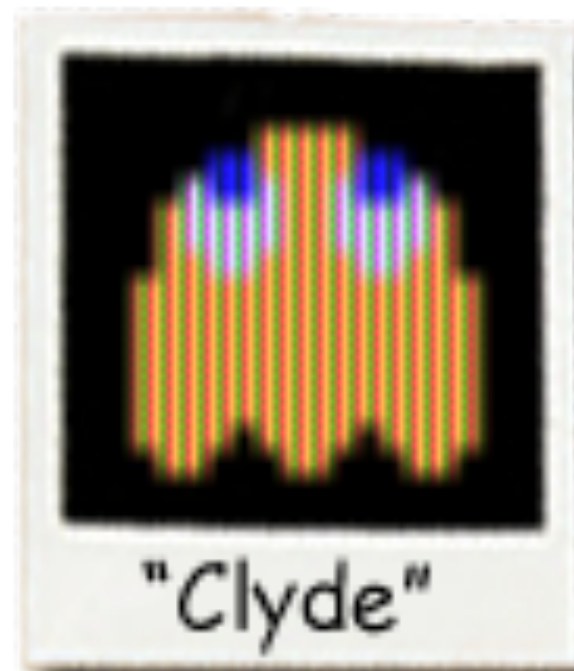
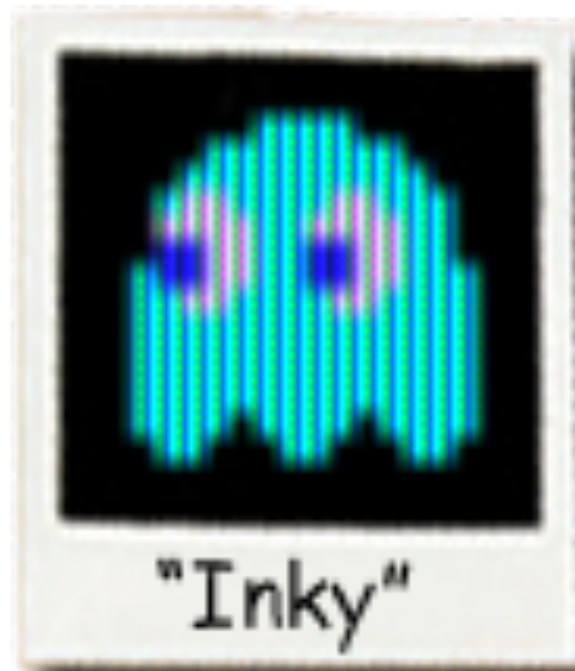




**Design Chase patterns
for Inky & Clyde!**



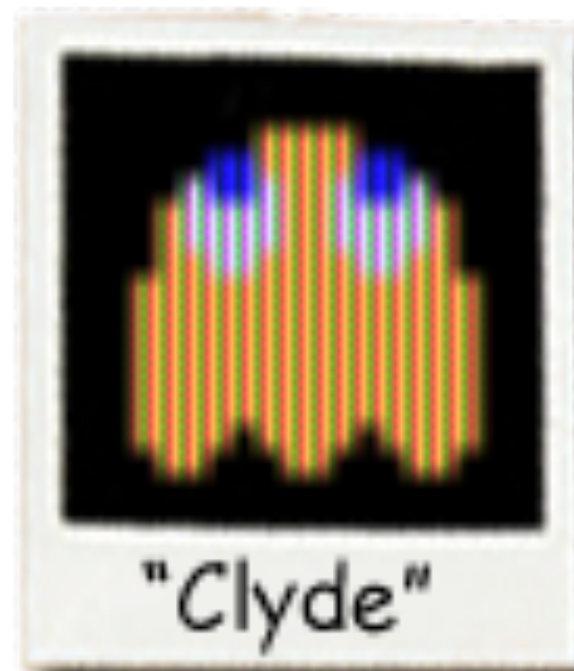
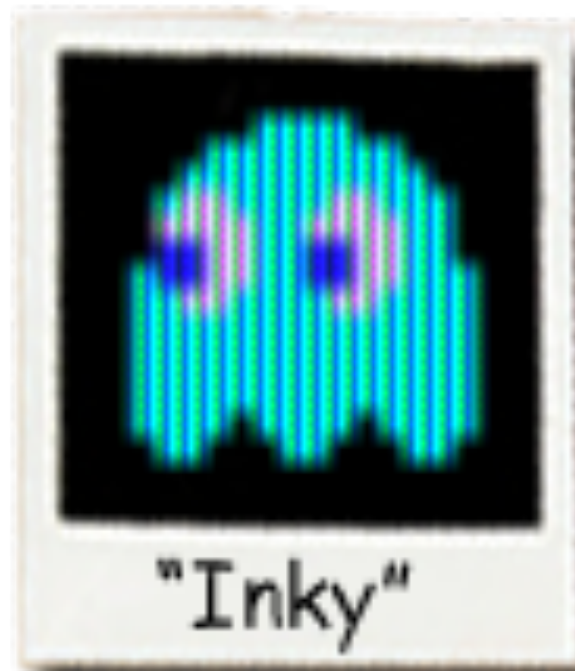
Pattern for Pac-Man ghosts



You can use positions of:

- Pac-Man
- Other ghosts
- Energisers, fruit, etc.

Fingerübung



**Remember:
Balance!
Game should be challenging but fun**

15 min!

Teams of 2

Pattern for Pac-Man ghosts

How does Pac-Man work?



You can use positions of:

- Pac-Man
- Other ghosts
- Energisers, fruit, etc.

Pattern for Pac-Man ghosts

How does Pac-Man work?

student variants Gruppe A

**kürzester Weg, der nicht von andrem Geist blockiert;
Guardian Ghost, random Energizer; wenn Frucht, dann dort Garden;
patrouilliert und wenn Pac Man nahe, dann auf ihn, für 50 Felder lang;
von Blinky abhängig, bissi hinten nach, vielleicht langsamer;
Quadranten mit nächstem Energizer oder Früchte oder random;
ein Tile hinter Pac-Man;**

"Inky"

Pattern for Pac-Man ghosts

How does Pac-Man work?

student variants Gruppe A

**nächster Energizer to Pac Man und nimmt den Scatter dort;
kopiert Zieltilelogik von random andrem Geist;
1 -> Richtung Frucht, 2-> wo wenigste Geister;
vollkommen random Position;
Quadranten mit meisten übrigen Punkten;
patrouilliert um Energizer, Frucht, sonst Scatter;**

"Clyde"

Pattern for Pac-Man ghosts

How does Pac-Man work?

student variants Gruppe B

**Durchschnitt zwischen Blinky und Pinky und dann gespiegelt;
patroulliert zw. random tile und energizer;
Energizer am nächsten zu Pac Man;
nächste Frucht, sonst Random;
Frucht, wenn vorhanden, sonst kleine Pellets, die grade gegessen
wurden;
Frucht, wenn vorhanden, sonst Energizer, sonst normale Pellets;
letzten 4 Richtungswechsel gespeichert und dann dorthin;
nächste Energizer zu Pac Man;**

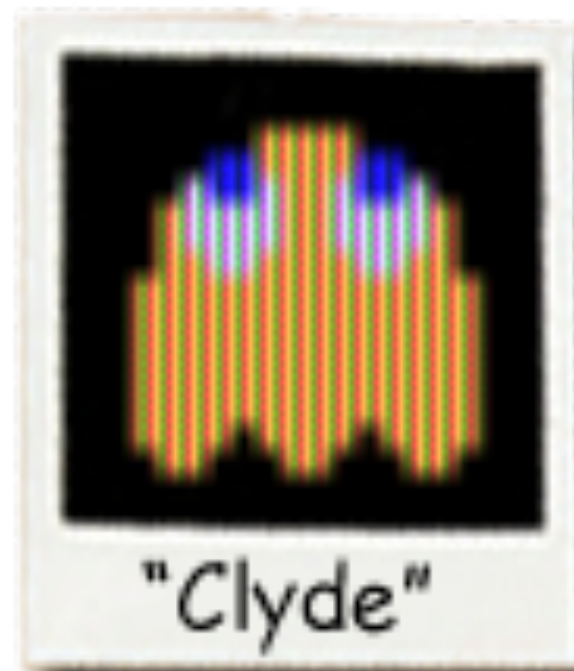
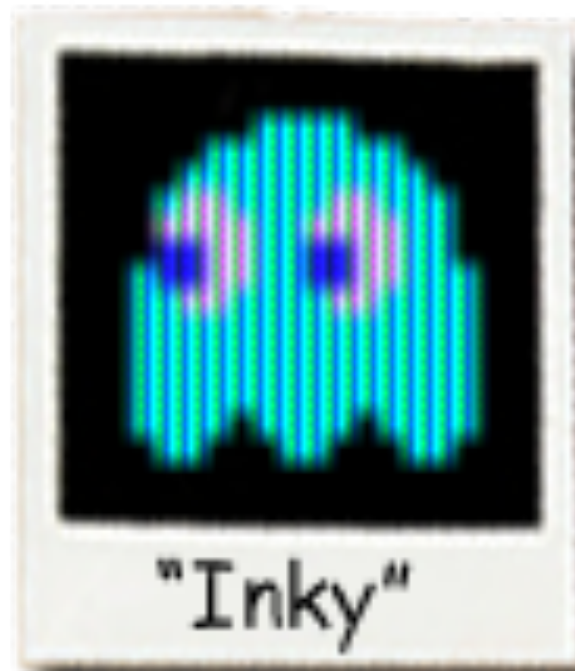
Pattern for Pac-Man ghosts

How does Pac-Man work?

student variants Gruppe B

**nächste Kreuzung oder nächste Wand von PacMan;
random decision bis Frucht kommt;
fährt in der Mitte herum, um Schnittstelle schwieriger zu machen;
schneidet Choke Points ab (Ausgänge);
Mitte guarden bis line of sight, dann direkt auf Pacman;
Teleporter links und rechts;
zu gewissen Intervallen Pac Man's Position und dann dort random;
Hinter Pac Man bis zur nächsten Frucht, dann Frucht;**

Pattern for Pac-Man ghosts



What are the original designer's patterns for Inky & Clyde?
Let's have a look!

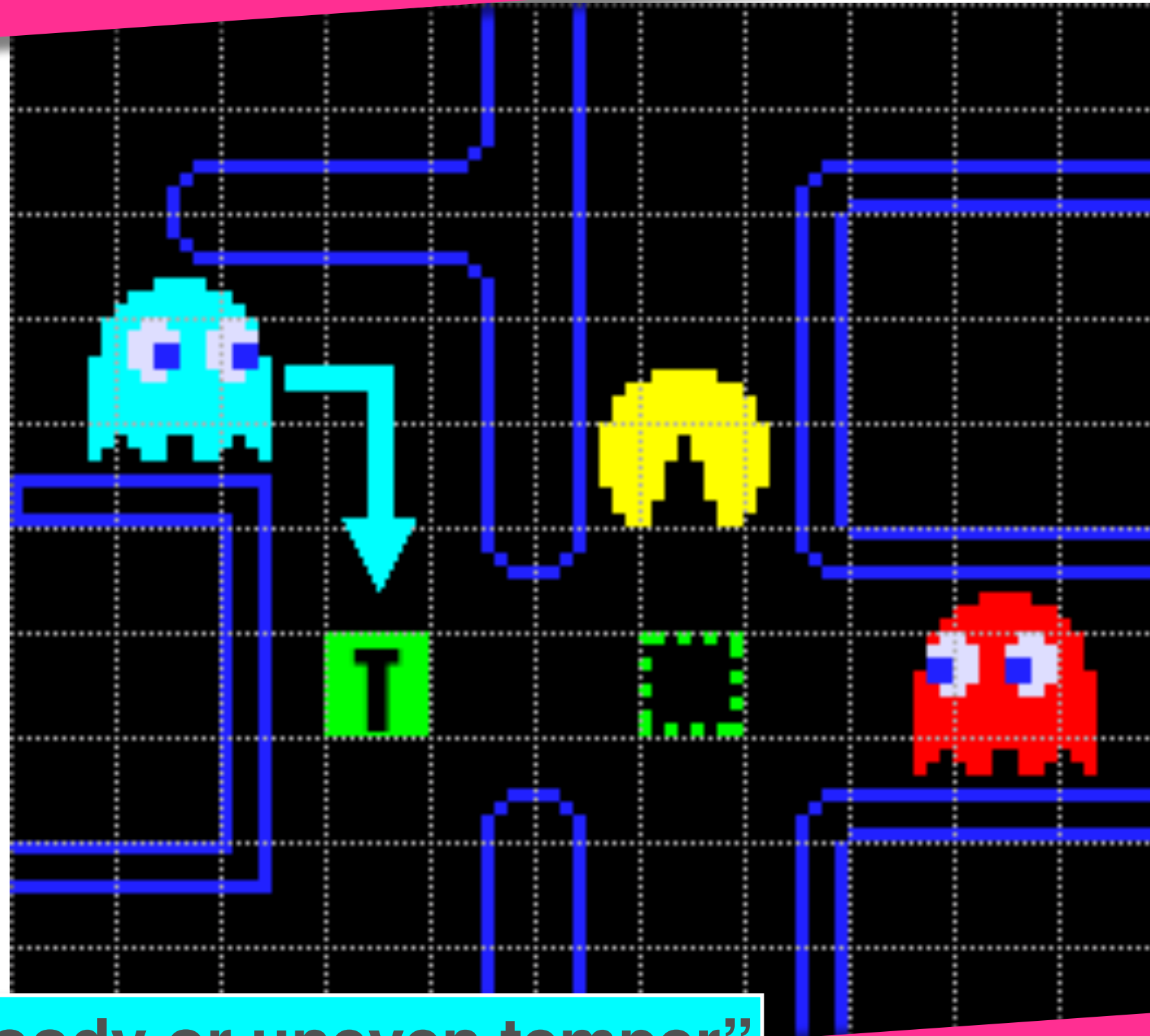
How does Pac-Man work?



**Kimagure: “a moody or uneven temper”
Uses Pac-Man’s and Blinky’s position**

Pattern for Pac-Man ghosts

How does PacMan work?



Kimagure: “a moody or uneven temper”
Uses Pac-Man’s and Blinky’s position

Pattern for Pac-Man ghosts

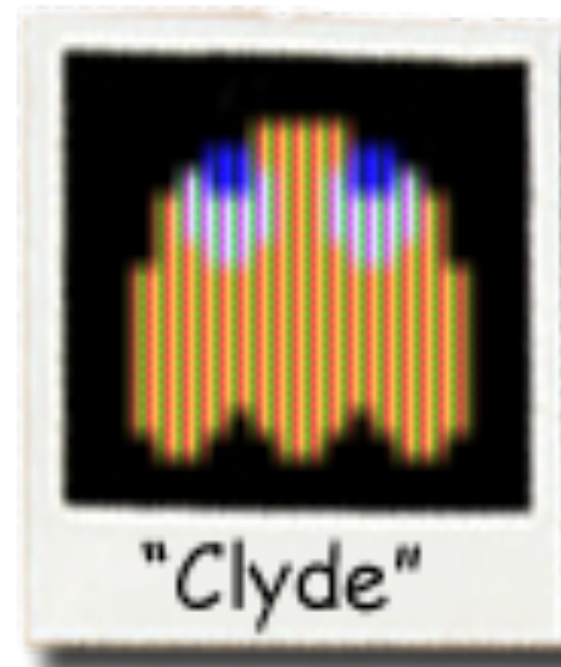
How does Pac-Man work?



Will keep away from Pac-Man when Blinky is far away
As Blinky draws closer, so will Inky

Pattern for Pac-Man ghosts

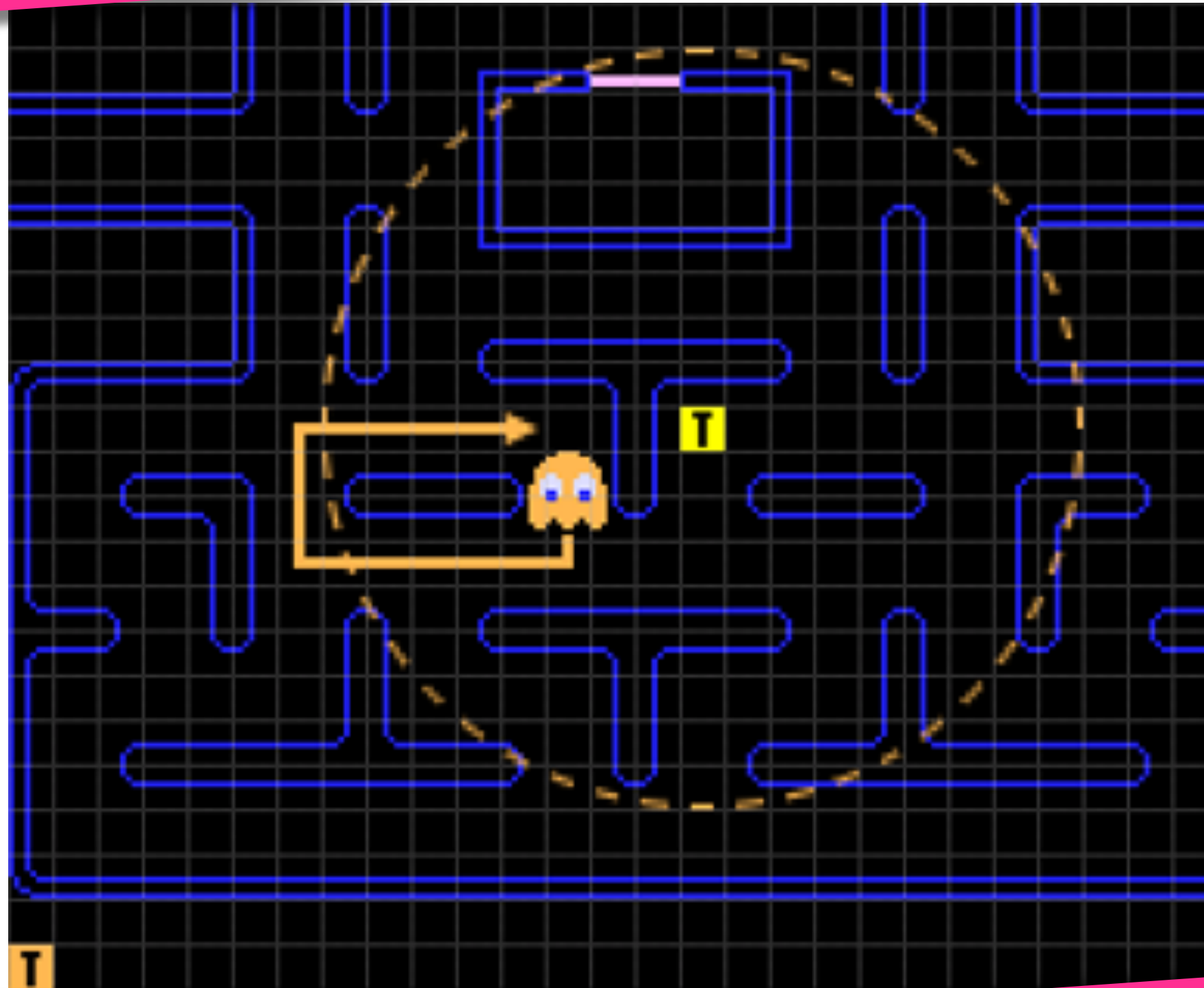
How does Pac-Man work?



**Otoboke: “pretending ignorance”
Moves away if too close to Pac-Man**

Pattern for Pac-Man ghosts

How does Pac-Man work?



Otoboke: “pretending ignorance” Moves away if too close to Pac-Man

Pattern for Pac-Man ghosts

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The Pac-Man Dossier by Jamey Pittman

<https://www.gamedeveloper.com/design/the-pac-man-dossier>

twitter.com/josefwho



Design Icons by Mark Brown, Game Maker's Toolkit

Day 1

Game Treatment

Josef Who?

Overview

What for/why?

How?

Where to begin?

What?

What for/why?

Strengthening of your design idea

Summary for publisher/funding

Summary for development team

Base for Design Bible

Submission(s)

How should it look?

Attractive and ready for publisher desk

Hardback, maybe a clear sheet at the front

Coloured image on cover helps selling it

10-15 pages without Concept Art

Index, sources (if available), imagery

Where to begin/how do you get to a treatment?

Analyse

Which genre?

Which other games are the most similar to yours?

What do you want to make differently than them?

What do you want to make similar to them?

Where to begin/how do you get to a treatment?

Evaluation

Will the feature lead to good gameplay?

Why has nobody thought of that before?

Is implementing the feature realistic for our team?

Is the feature manageable/controllable?

Where to begin/how do you get to a treatment?

Justification

Presentation for publisher/team/Jury/MMP3/...

Don't be sensitive!

Don't take it personal

What?

1. Cover Page

Game Name

Tagline

Authors

Date

Copyright

Screenshot or Concept Art

What?

2. Summary

Most important points

Highlights

Can to some degree be copy-pasted from the rest

Write it as the very last thing

What?

3. Game Description part 1

Extended high concept tagline

Description of 5-6 best features

If needed description of licences (sport, film, music,...)

What?

3. Game Description part 2

Gameplay highlights

Interface, mission design, ...

Online/Multitplayer highlights

Coop, Chat, ...

Tech highlights

Facial animation, procedural level design, ...

What?

3. Game Description part 3

Art & Audio Design

Design is based on, ...

Hardware

System requirements, ...

What?

4. Game World

Background story

Goals

Character descriptions

Mission and story progress

Concept art

Screenshots

What?

5. Production Details

Who is developing?

Short team member bios

Who is responsible for and good at what?

Costs

Try to budget your game idea

Project plan

Time line, ...

What?

6. Competition/Market analysis

What is currently in development or already out there?

Name, system, studio, release date

What are the highlights of those projects?

What does your game do differently?

What does your game do better?

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FEEDBACK PLEASE!
ANY QUESTIONS SO FAR?

Josef Who?

Day 1

MDA Framework

Game Studies & Game Design 2

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Many different approaches to Game Design!

MDA Framework

Many different approaches to Game Design!

E.g. Jesse Schell, The Art of Game Design

Looking at game design through lenses





Many different approaches to Game Design!

E.g. Chris Barney, Pattern Language for Game Design

Looking at game design through patterns



Many different approaches to Game Design!

MDA Framework

Looking at game design from dev and gamer perspective

Many different approaches to Game Design!

Many many more,....

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Mechanics, Dynamics, Aesthetics

**A formal approach to Game Design
by Robin Hunicke, Marc Le Blanc & Robert Zubek**

MDA Framework

Designer

creates



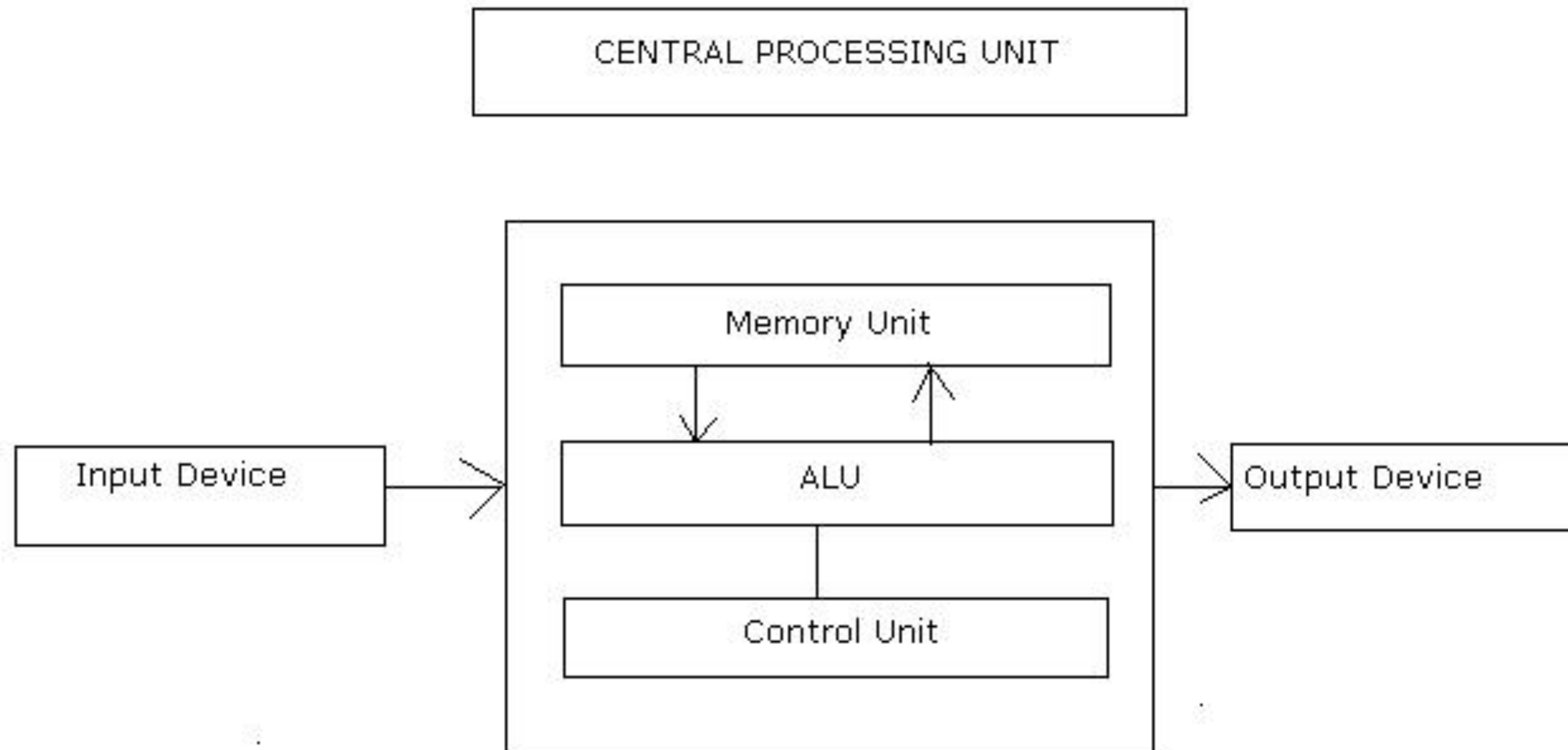
Game

consumes

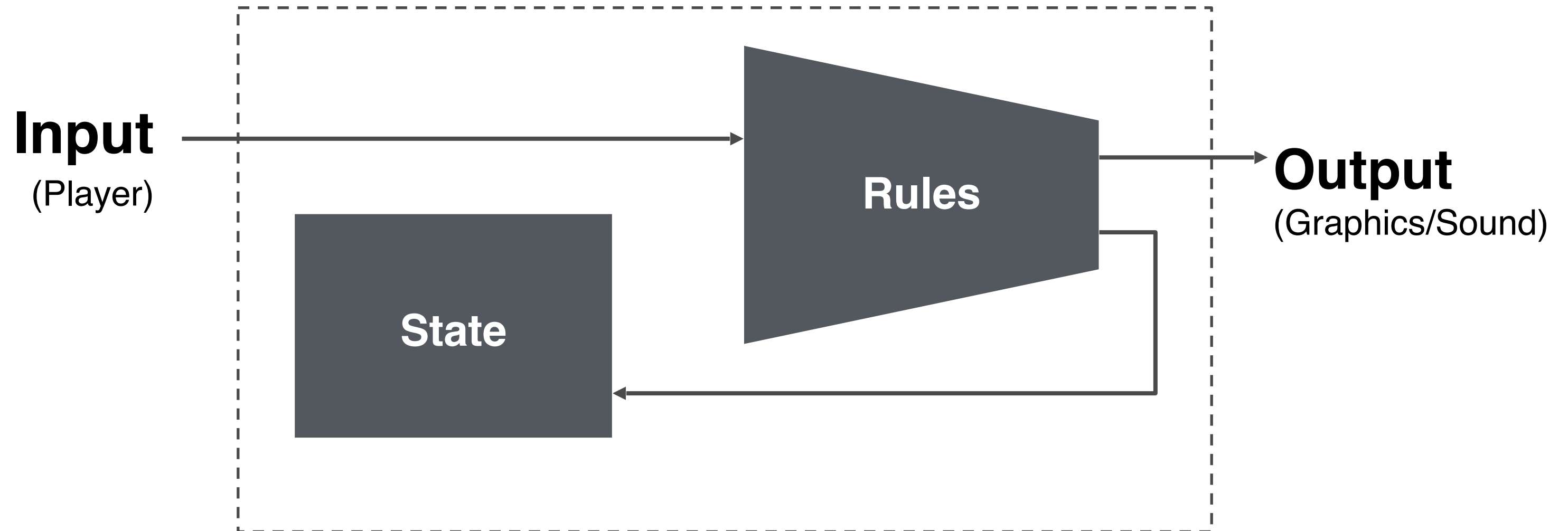


Player

Anatomy of a computer



Anatomy of a game



MDA Framework

Software/Games

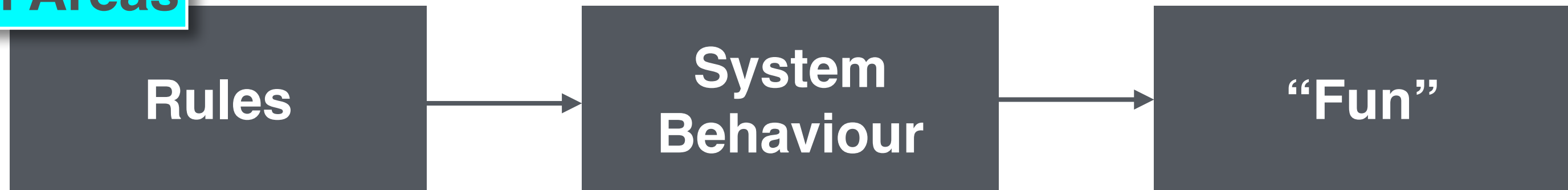


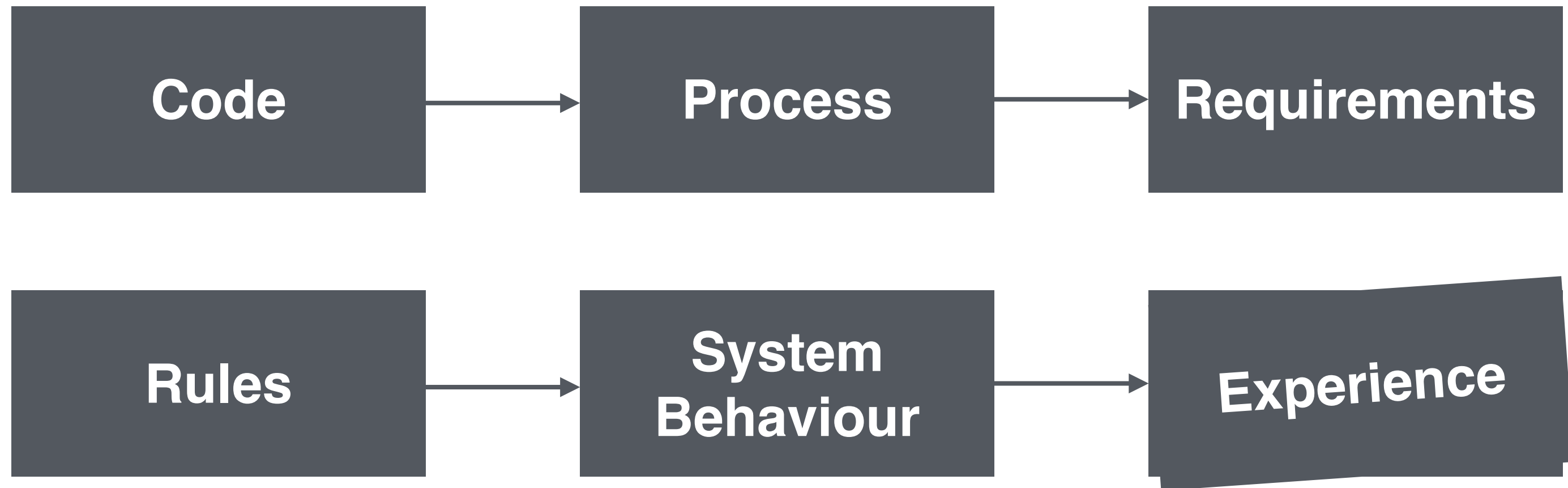
MDA Framework

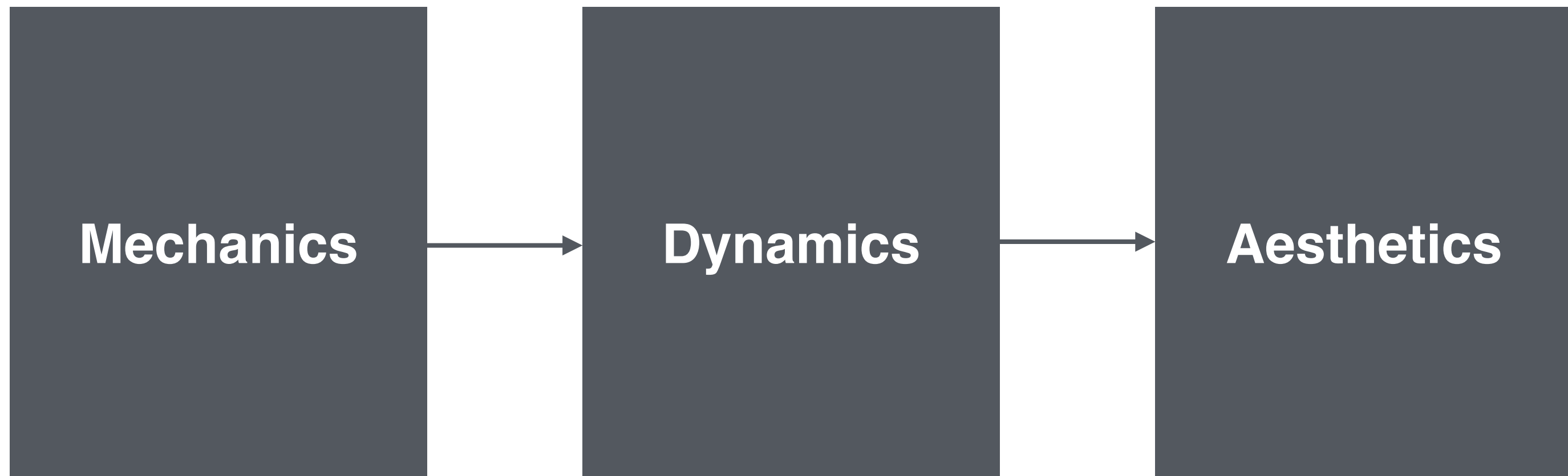
Processes



Design Areas







**A formal approach that is a vocabulary
so we can talk about design.**

Mechanics:

are the particular components of the game, at a level of data representation and algorithms. Code, rules, content, naming etc.

Dynamics:

The run-time behaviour of the Mechanics.

Aesthetics:

The desirable emotional responses evoked by the game's Dynamics.

Fundamental to this framework is the idea that games are more like artefacts than media.

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The content of a game is its behaviour...

MDA Framework

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more than the media that streams out of it

MDA Framework

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The goal of Sissyfight is to reduce your opponent's self-esteem to zero.

Sissyfight 3000

Every player has:

A color

10 self-esteem points

Action cards (SOLO, TEAM, DEFEND)

Target cards (the other players' colour)

Each round

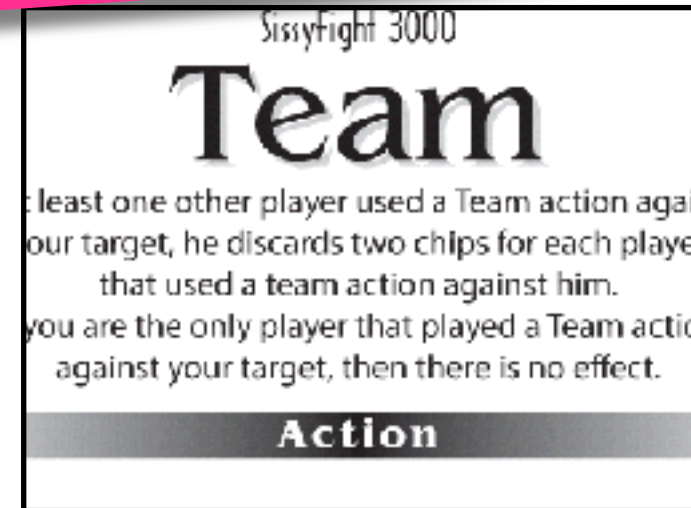
**Choose an action and a target in secret.
You can plot with other players in public.
Don't whisper, don't show cards, etc.
Final choice must be secret.**

After everyone has chosen

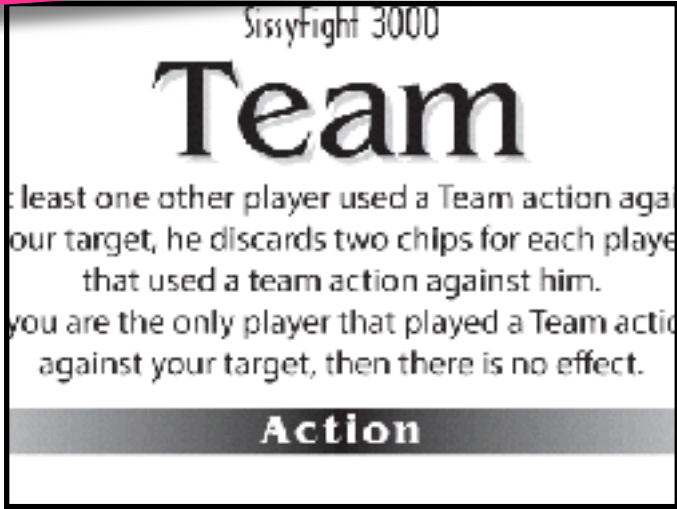
**Everyone reveals at the same time.
Resolve actions.
Deduct self-esteem points.**



**SOLO attacks player of chosen colour.
TARGET loses one self-esteem point.**



TEAM has no effect if you are the only one playing that combo.



**TEAM only effective if at least 2 actions with same target.
-2 self-esteem points for each Team card.**





**DEFEND always played with NO TARGET card.
Only need to discard half the points. (no half points)
But if no-one attacked you: -1 self-esteem point.**

Mechanics

Experience

What are the Mechanics of Sissyfight?

**Gruppe A:
Punkteanzahl; Benennung;
Karten mit Bedeutung;
Setup, Prozesse: Regeln**

Experience

What kinds of fun did you experience?

Aesthetics

Gruppe A:

Teambuilding; Verrat; Empörung; Gruppendynamik

Mechanics

Experience

What are the Mechanics of Sissyfight?

**Gruppe B:
Karten; Kommunikation; Regeln;
Setup; Prozesse;
Win-, Losecondition; Benennung**

Experience

What kinds of fun did you experience? →

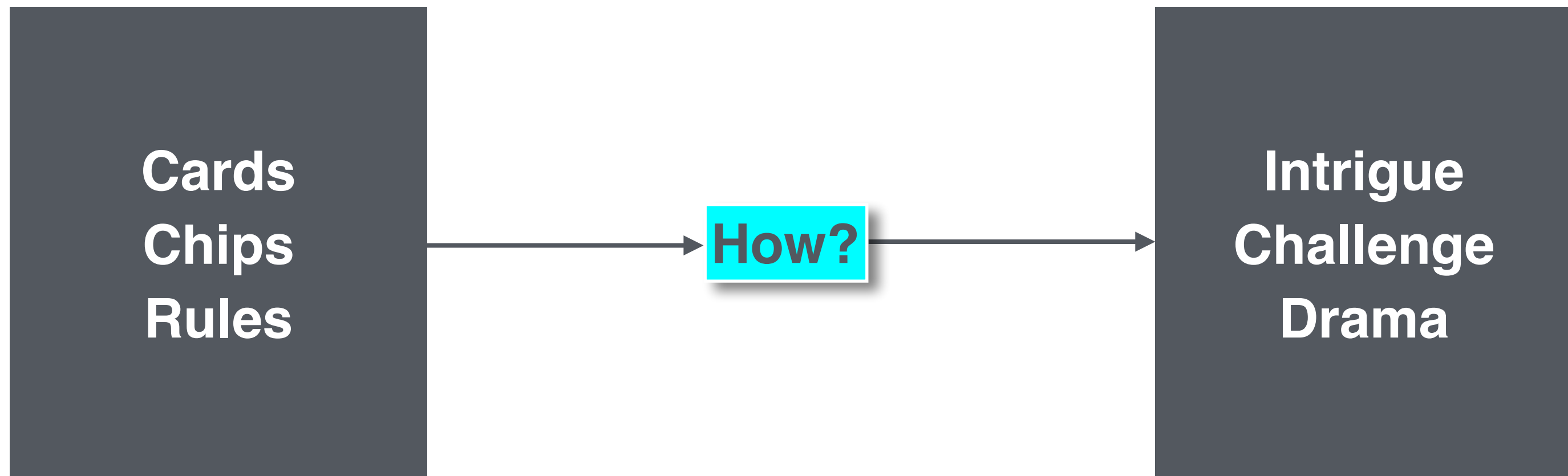
Aesthetics

Gruppe B:

Gruppendynamik; Bluffen; Intrige; Bullying/Mobbing

More specific than “fun”

Intrigue: Negotiation, Cooperation, Betrayal
Challenge: Tactics, Problem Solving
Drama: Narrative Arc



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Your turn!

Sissyfight 3000

Day 1

Adapt Sissyfight 3000

Game Design & Playable Media

Exercise

Choose a new fictional genre and/or setting that might fit this game. >>> Aesthetics

Adapt the game to your chosen subject matter.

How can the rules, content etc. of the game be changed to best support your fiction? >>> Mechanics

MDA Framework

Process:

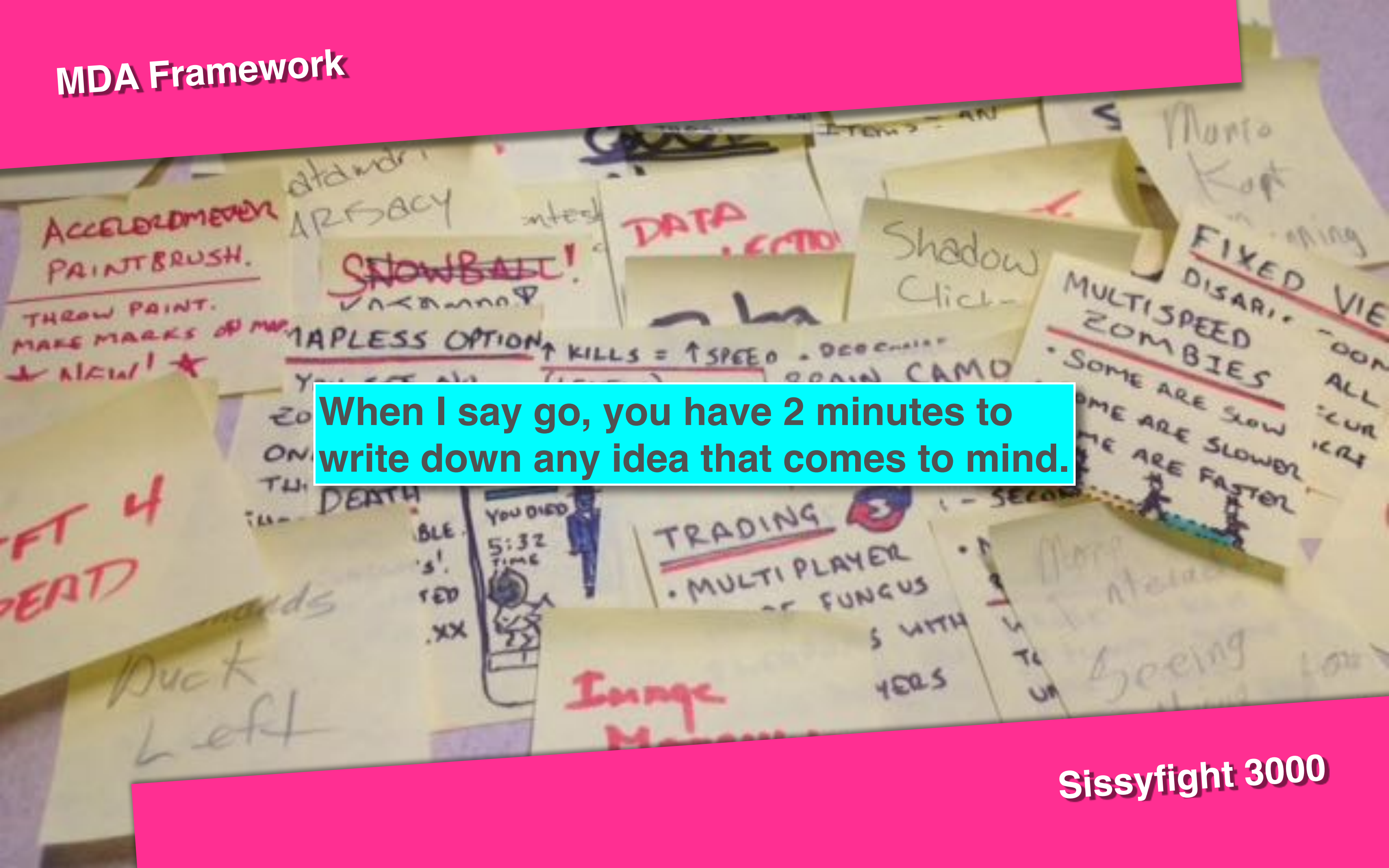
Brainstorm alone

Filter and choose Aesthetics in team

Adapt game (Mechanics) in team

Sissyfight 3000

MDA Framework



When I say go, you have 2 minutes to write down any idea that comes to mind.

Sissyfight 3000

MDA Framework

Organise in teams

Sissyfight 3000

MDA Framework

Adapt the game.

Sissyfight 3000

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Game Studies & Game Design 2

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